

Value-Aligned AI Reflective Diaries for Adolescent Emotional Support

Can an anonymous, safety-constrained AI diary help students feel understood and name one safer next step?

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Problem

Many teenagers begin with private worries: school pressure, family conflict, relationship stress, identity confusion, or uncertainty about the future. They may not be ready to talk to a counselor, parent, or teacher.

low-pressure support anonymous reflection privacy first

Research Question

After using a value-aligned anonymous AI reflective diary, do students report higher understanding, less loneliness, more self-acceptance, a safer next step, and more patience toward their concern?

Prototype

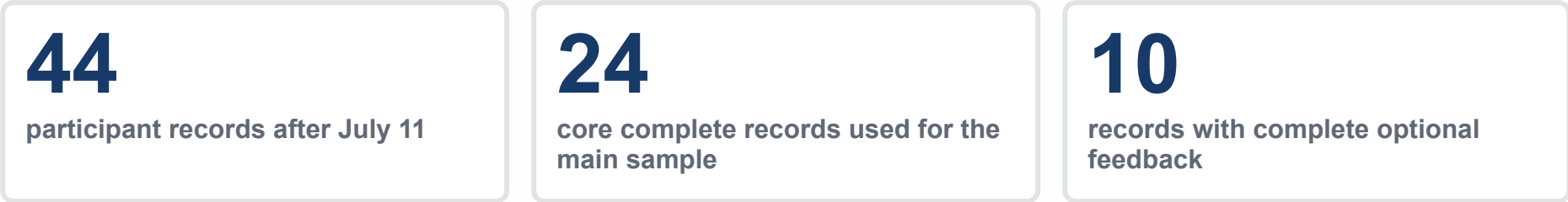


The web tool begins with consent, privacy warnings, and a non-clinical safety boundary. Users can also return later to reread saved anonymous diaries in the same browser.

1. Consent voluntary, anonymous, non-clinical	2. Pre-survey five 1-5 items before reflection	3. AI diary reflective story plus safer next step
4. Post-survey same five items after reading	5. Diary book review past anonymous diaries later	6. Feedback optional open response

Method

Design: within-subject pre-post prototype evaluation. Users completed the same five-item scale before and after reading the AI diary.



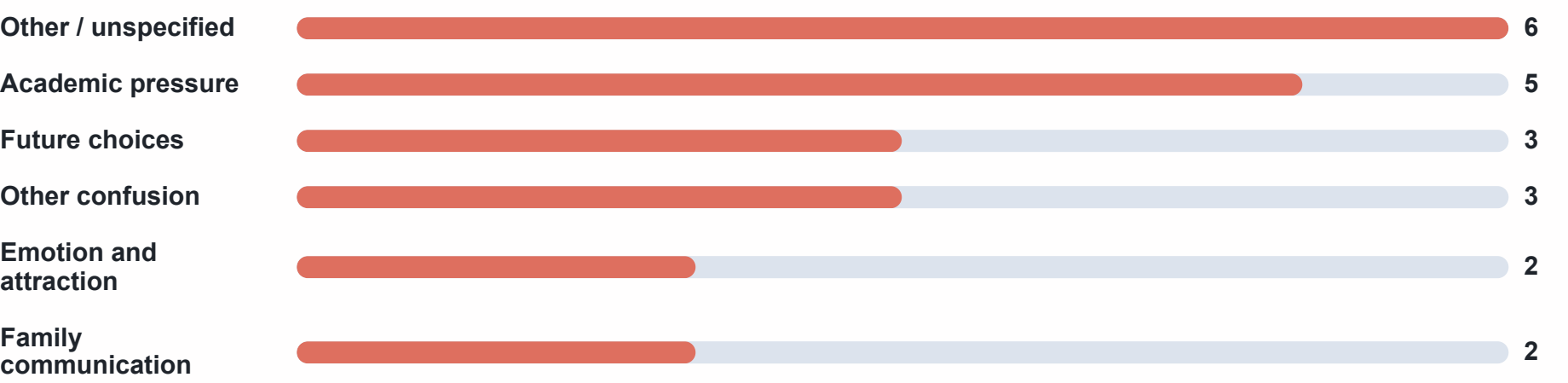
Cutoff: July 11, 2026, 00:00 Asia/Singapore and after. Core complete means pre-survey, post-survey, and an AI diary record were all present.

Measure

The five survey items asked whether the user felt understood, less alone, more accepting of confusion, able to name one safer next step, and willing to give the concern more patience. Five items were rated 1-5, so total scores ranged from 5 to 25. Higher scores indicate stronger agreement with the support outcomes.

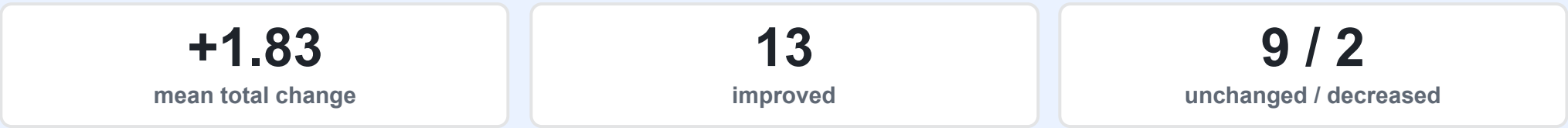
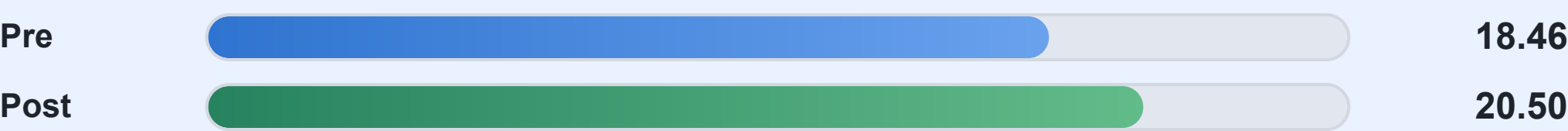
Topics Students Chose

Usage broadened beyond identity questions into everyday emotional pressure.



Results

In the 24 core complete records, total scores moved upward on average.



These results are descriptive and early. They suggest possible short-term support, not clinical effectiveness.

Safety and Ethics

The central design choice was to make AI support helpful without pretending to be therapy.

No diagnosis or mental-health labeling	No prediction of sexual orientation or identity
No collection of names, schools, contacts, or exact locations	Redirects serious risk toward trusted adults or professional help

Meaning

The prototype may lower the first barrier to help-seeking by giving students a private way to name a concern, feel less judged, and identify one manageable next step.

! Limitations: small convenience sample, no control group, self-report outcomes, and no evidence of long-term or clinical impact.

Try the Demo



Scan to open the anonymous reflective diary prototype.
www.ava-design.net